

TeacherGuide4-Till-Operating-Instructor

TEACHER'S GUIDE — Till Operating & ICT (2-Week Course)

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COURSE OVERVIEW FOR TRAINER

Your goal: Turn a complete beginner into a job-ready cashier in 10 days. Every minute counts.

What students fear most: Making mistakes with money. Your job is to make them confident through repetition — not just theory.

DAY-BY-DAY TRAINER NOTES

Day 1 — Intro to Retail (Module 1)

Trainer Preparation: - Print 10 “role play customer” cards with different shopping scenarios - Prepare a list of 10 Zimbabwean retail shops as examples - Have pens and notebooks ready for all students

Key Points to Emphasise: - The retail sector employs thousands in Zimbabwe — this skill opens real doors - Cashiers are the FACE of the business — first and last impression - Integrity is non-negotiable — make this clear from day one

Common Student Questions: - Q: “Do I need O-Levels?” A: No. NtandoMods is open to everyone. - Q: “Will I get a job after this?” A: Retail employers actively look for certified cashiers.

Role Play Tips: - Pair confident students with shy ones - Model the greeting yourself first so students know what “good” looks like - Give positive feedback loudly, correction feedback quietly

Day 2 — POS Systems (Module 2)

Trainer Preparation: - If you have a practice POS — set it up the night before - If no POS: print the POS diagram from the module and laminate it - Prepare 20 product cards with barcodes (can be hand-drawn)

Teaching the POS Without Real Hardware: Use this sequence: 1. Show diagram of POS components — students label their own copy 2. Demonstrate login procedure verbally (or on a laptop simulation) 3. Do a “barcode scan” role play: one student is the “scanner” (calls out price), one is the cashier (types it)

Common Mistakes to Watch For: - Students confusing void and refund — address this today, not on Day 3 - Students not knowing where to place their fingers on keypad — show them

Day 3 — Transactions (Module 3)

Trainer Preparation: - Prepare cash (real or printed fake notes) for change-giving practice - Print receipt templates - Write 5 transaction scenarios on slips of paper

The Change-Giving Drill (most important exercise of the week): Run this drill 20+ times until every student can give change without hesitation: 1. Trainer announces: “Total is \$7.40. Customer pays \$10.” 2. Student counts out change: “Here is \$2.60 — \$2 and 60 cents.” 3. Trainer varies amounts until students stop counting on fingers

Trainer Tip: Students who struggle with arithmetic need extra practice. Pair them with a strong student for the change-giving drill.

Day 4 — Cash Handling (Module 4)

Trainer Preparation: - Prepare envelopes with mixed notes/coins for counting exercises - Print Z-Read report templates - Print cash-up sheets

The Counting Race (engagement activity): Give each student an envelope with the same mixed amount. First student to count it correctly AND record it on the cash-up sheet wins. This builds speed under pressure.

Teaching Fake Note Detection: If you don't have a UV light — teach the feel and visual test instead: - Pass around a genuine \$1 or \$5 USD note - Ask students: "What do you notice about the texture? The watermark?" - Emphasise: when in doubt, call the supervisor — don't accuse the customer

Day 5 — Customer Service & Security (Module 5)

Trainer Preparation: - Prepare 4 "difficult customer" scenario cards - Optional: film one role play to show students what professional looks like

The Difficult Customer Role Play (key exercise): This must feel real. Trainer should play the difficult customer — be genuinely frustrated. Students must handle it professionally. Debrief after each: - What did they do well? - What could they improve? - How did it feel? (normalise that it's uncomfortable — real life is too)

Week 1 Summary: - Do a 15-question verbal quiz at end of Day 5 covering the full week - Students who cannot answer basic change-giving or void/refund questions need weekend practice

Days 6–9 — ICT Basics (Modules 6–9)

Essential Rule for ICT Teaching: NEVER talk about computers for more than 15 minutes without having students on the computers doing something. ICT is learned by doing.

If Computers Are Limited (fewer computers than students): - Pair students (one types, one guides — swap every 20 minutes) - Use printed keyboard diagrams for finger placement practice - Use phone (Android) as a substitute for Excel/Word practice if needed

Typing Practice Schedule: - 15 minutes of typing practice at the START of every ICT day - Use online typing tools if internet is available (typing.com, keybr.com) - Track each student's WPM daily and show them their improvement

Excel — The #1 Struggle Point: Most students will struggle with formulas. Use this sequence: 1. First teach with calculator: "3+3 = 6. Excel does the same thing." 2. Then show: =3+3 in a cell. Press enter. Magic. 3. Then cell references: =A1+A2. Move to =SUM(A1:A5). 4. NEVER skip ahead — wait until everyone understands each step.

Day 10 — Assessment Day (Module 10)

Morning Routine: - 1-hour revision session — students ask questions, you clarify - Run through the most common exam questions verbally - Remind students: read every question carefully. Don't rush.

During the Written Exam: - Walk the room every 10 minutes - If a student is stuck on a question — remind them to move on and come back - Keep exact time — start and stop on the dot

Practical Assessment: - Set up the till area before students arrive - Have all scenario cards ready - Mark each student on the rubric as they go — don't rely on memory - Give brief verbal feedback immediately after each practical

Certificate Day: - Print certificates the night before - Write each student's name neatly (or print) - Call each student by name to receive their certificate - Photograph the moment (with permission)

FREQUENTLY ASKED TRAINER QUESTIONS

Q: What if a student fails? A: They get one free rewrite within 30 days. If they fail the rewrite, they must re-enrol.

Q: What if I don't have a real POS machine? A: Use the printed simulation in the course materials. Many employers will train on their specific system after hiring — your job is to teach the concepts and confidence.

Q: What if students don't speak English well? A: Teach in English but allow Shona/Ndebele explanations for complex concepts. The workplace will require English, so build that habit gently.

Q: A student is clearly struggling with the course. What do I do? A: Give them extra one-on-one time during breaks. If they are genuinely unable to keep up, speak to management — they may need to repeat certain modules.